SERVICE REQUEST MANAGEMENT

Purpose, service channels & document map

CH-SRM-01 | Version 1.0 | Effective 01 Sep 2026

About Cedarhaven. The Town of Cedarhaven is a fictional Ontario municipality created for a technical recruitment exercise. This operational guide describes its simulated municipal 311 service-request process. It is not a real government policy, contact directory or statement of Canadian law.

> Core service promise. Residents can report non-emergency municipal service issues through one front door, receive a tracking number, and check progress. Submitting a request does not guarantee that the Town will approve a permit, issue a by-law penalty, or complete work by a particular date.

Use this guide for

- Missed curbside waste collection and damaged municipal bins.
- Potholes, damaged street signs, municipal streetlights and blocked catch basins.
- Park maintenance, fallen public trees and unsafe municipal pathways.
- Request intake, classification, response targets, status tracking and escalation.

Find information quickly

Page	Section	Topics
2	SRM 1	Intake, contact channels, evidence and accessibility
3	SRM 2	Priority levels, assessment windows and response targets
4	SRM 3	Waste and missed-collection rules
5	SRM 4	Roads, lighting, drainage and water
6	SRM 5	Parks, trees, sidewalks and seasonal services
7	SRM 6	Tracking statuses, notifications and reopening
8	SRM 7	Duplicates, escalation, privacy and cross-service routing

> Document boundary. For by-law investigation procedures, use CH-BYL-02. For building permits, business licences and encroachment applications, use CH-PER-03. If a detail is absent from all supplied documents, do not guess it.

SERVICE REQUEST MANAGEMENT

SRM 1 | How to submit a service request

Contact routes, intake fields and what happens next

1.1 Accepted channels

Channel	Availability / what to expect
Cedarhaven Service Portal	Available for electronic submissions at any time; automated reference number after successful submission.
311 contact centre	Staffed Monday-Friday, 8:30 a.m.-4:30 p.m., excluding Town-observed holidays.
Town Hall front desk	Staff can help record requests during the same business hours; no separate priority.
Accessible intake	Residents may request telephone assistance or alternate-format confirmation via 311 during staffed hours.

The guide deliberately does not provide a public website URL, street address, email address or telephone number other than the generic 311 service name. Do not invent one.

1.2 Intake information

- Required: issue category, location or nearest intersection, clear description, and date first noticed (if known).
- Useful but optional: photo, hazard description, reference landmark, and a contact method for updates.
- For a missed collection, the collection date, material type, set-out time and bin condition are additionally needed (see page 4).
- Requests involving private property may require landowner consent before municipal staff can enter.

1.3 Eligibility and ownership

The 311 team checks whether the issue concerns a Town-owned asset or Town-managed service. It may forward eligible by-law complaints to Enforcement and permit questions to Development Services. Routing is not a promise that an investigation or approval will occur.

> Safety first. For immediate danger to life, fire, suspected gas leaks or a serious active medical emergency, contact emergency services. Do not treat a 311 submission as an emergency response. For an immediate water-main break, contact 311 during staffed hours; outside those hours the guide does not provide an after-hours phone number.

SERVICE REQUEST MANAGEMENT

SRM 2 | Priority and response standards

Targets describe first response, not guaranteed completion

2.1 Service priority matrix

Priority	Example / trigger	Initial action target
P1 - urgent	Open sinkhole, downed electrical wire, exposed sharp debris on a busy public path.	Staff assessment within 4 staffed hours; make-safe action targeted within 1 business day when feasible.
P2 - high	Damaged stop sign, severe drainage blocking an arterial road, large fallen limb obstructing a sidewalk.	Assessment within 1 business day; work scheduling after assessment.
P3 - standard	Routine pothole, flickering streetlight, ordinary park litter.	Assessment within 3 business days; work according to service-specific targets.
P4 - information	General question, follow-up or request that needs another department.	Acknowledgement within 2 business days; referral if appropriate.

2.2 How time is measured

- Business day: Monday-Friday excluding Town-observed holidays.
- Staffed hour: time within the 8:30 a.m.-4:30 p.m. weekday contact-centre schedule.
- An online request filed outside staffed hours enters the triage queue at the next staffed opening.
- Targets can change following field assessment, severe weather, contractor availability or access restrictions.

2.3 Distinguish the milestones

Acknowledgement confirms receipt and issues a case identifier. Assessment identifies severity, jurisdiction and next action. Make-safe addresses an immediate hazard. Resolution records the final outcome. These are not interchangeable.

> Important exception. A fallen overhead utility wire is treated as an immediate hazard; residents must keep clear and contact emergency services or the utility provider. A 311 case can be recorded for coordination, but it must not delay the emergency notification.

SERVICE REQUEST MANAGEMENT

SRM 3 | Curbside waste and missed collection

Eligibility criteria, evidence, collection attempt and exceptions

3.1 When to report a missed pickup

A missed garbage, recycling or organics pickup may be reported after 7:00 p.m. on the scheduled collection day and within two business days after that day. Early reports are recorded as inquiries, not confirmed missed-collection service requests.

3.2 What residents must provide

- Full service address, material stream (garbage, recycling or organics), scheduled collection date and time the bin was set out.
- Whether the bin was visible and accessible at the curb by 7:00 a.m. on collection day.
- Whether a rejection tag was attached, the lid was closed, and any vehicle or snowbank blocked access.
- A photo is helpful but not mandatory; personal contact information is optional unless an update is requested.

3.3 Eligibility and attempt window

Situation	Town response
On-time, compliant set-out; no obstruction	Accept missed-collection case and target a return pickup within 2 business days after validation.
Bin placed out after 7:00 a.m.	Not eligible for a missed-pickup return; advise next scheduled day.
Rejection tag for contamination / oversized contents	Not eligible until corrected; advise resident to follow collection rules.
Blocked by parked vehicle, snowbank or inaccessible gate	May be declined; resident should remove the obstruction before next service.

After a valid report, residents should leave the bin at the curb until 7:00 p.m. of the next business day, unless doing so creates a safety obstruction. A return pickup is a target, not a guarantee.

> Collection schedule gap. This document intentionally does not publish street-by-street pickup days, holiday collection schedules, missed-collection fines or the full list of acceptable recyclable materials. The assistant should not infer those details.

SERVICE REQUEST MANAGEMENT

SRM 4 | Roads, streetlights, drainage and water

Category-specific routing and field service standards

4.1 Potholes and roadway surfaces

For routine potholes on Town-maintained roads (P3), Roads Operations targets an assessment within 3 business days and a repair within 15 business days after assessment, subject to weather and materials. Report the nearest address or intersection, travel direction, lane and hazard size if safe.

A road collapse, sinkhole or hazard causing immediate danger is P1; see page 3. Provincial highways, private roads and roads outside Cedarhaven are referred to their owners and are not scheduled as Town repairs.

4.2 Streetlights and traffic signs

Issue	Target or rule
Flickering or unlit Town streetlight	P3 assessment within 3 business days; repair target 10 business days after assessment if Town-owned.
Damaged stop sign	P2 initial assessment within 1 business day; make-safe / temporary control according to field risk.
Traffic-signal outage	Urgent safety referral to Roads Operations; if traffic is dangerous contact emergency services.
Private driveway or private parking-lot light	Outside the Town streetlight program; contact property owner.

4.3 Flooding and blocked catch basins

A blocked catch basin with standing water but no immediate roadway danger is normally P2 if a road is affected, otherwise P3. Flooding entering occupied buildings or undermining a roadway requires urgent safety escalation; do not promise a drainage response time beyond the priority assessment target.

4.4 Suspected water-main break

Provide the location, visible leak description and any hazard. 311 records a referral to Water Operations. Water shutoff time, repair completion time and compensation eligibility are not defined in this guide. Residents should avoid affected areas and follow any official safety direction.

SERVICE REQUEST MANAGEMENT

SRM 5 | Parks, trees and seasonal maintenance

Service ownership, environmental factors and boundaries

5.1 Parks and pathways

Issue	Guidance
Overflowing garbage bin in a Town park	P3 assessment within 3 business days; cleaning target within 5 business days after assessment.
Broken play-equipment component	Classify P1 if imminent injury risk; otherwise P2; field team decides whether to close the feature.
Unsafe debris or glass on busy public pathway	P1 if acute injury risk, otherwise P2 or P3 after assessment.
Graffiti on Town-owned park structure	P3 assessment; cleaning target within 10 business days after assessment.

5.2 Public and private trees

For a tree or large branch blocking a public sidewalk, record location, obstruction and visible hazard; usually P2. For a downed tree resting on a power line, keep clear and seek emergency/utility assistance. Routine public-tree pruning is P3, with field scheduling dependent on season and arborist availability.

A tree entirely on private property is generally the owner's responsibility. If it violates a property-maintenance standard or creates an apparent nuisance, the resident may submit a by-law complaint under CH-BYL-02; municipal crews do not automatically cut private trees.

5.3 Sidewalk and winter-maintenance reports

- Broken municipal sidewalk slab: routine P3 unless an acute trip hazard raises the priority.
- Snow or ice on a Town sidewalk: assess according to weather event and pedestrian safety; normal time-to-clear is not published here.
- Snow or ice on a private frontage: may be a by-law matter under CH-BYL-02; the Town does not guarantee private-property clearing via 311.

> Limits. No routine street-sweeping dates, park opening hours, tree-pruning calendar, snowplow map or road-closure schedule are specified in these recruitment documents.

SERVICE REQUEST MANAGEMENT

SRM 6 | Request lifecycle and resident updates

A trackable case is not the same as an approved action

6.1 Standard status definitions

Status	Meaning / action
Submitted	Request received and assigned a reference number; completeness not yet checked.
Under Review	Staff checks scope, location, evidence, duplication and priority.
Assigned	Responsible Town work group or partner has accepted the item for assessment or action.
Scheduled	Work visit or next action planned; no fixed appointment implied.
In Progress	Field or desk team has started the task or investigation.
Completed	Town has recorded its action or final decision; may include referral or no-work-required outcome.
Closed - Not Eligible	Outside jurisdiction, duplicate, insufficient information or ineligible service.

6.2 How updates work

- The Service Portal shows the current status and most recent status note for users with a valid case reference.
- If the resident supplied an email and opted into updates, a notification is sent when the case is Assigned, Scheduled or Completed.
- If the resident did not provide contact details, the case can still be processed, but proactive personal notifications are unavailable.
- Sensitive enforcement information may be withheld from the resident-facing case notes.

6.3 Reopening

A resident may request review of a completed service request within five business days after its completion if the reported condition persists. Reopening is discretionary after staff verification; after five business days, a new case should generally be filed. By-law investigations have separate disclosure and appeal procedures (CH-BYL-02).

> Dates matter. A Scheduled status is not a guaranteed visit date. The published performance targets concern categories and initial actions; never invent an individual crew appointment or a specific arrival time.

SERVICE REQUEST MANAGEMENT

SRM 7 | Duplicates, escalation and cross-service routing

Protect resident privacy and avoid the wrong workflow

7.1 Duplicate prevention

Requests may be considered duplicates if they concern the same location, issue category and observed condition within 72 hours, subject to staff review. A resident may be linked to the existing case rather than given an independent repair schedule. Materially worsening hazards are re-triaged even when an earlier case exists.

7.2 Escalation rules

- If a P3 request has not been assessed after 3 business days, residents may ask 311 for a status review.
- If a category-specific completion target has passed, 311 may send a follow-up to the owning work group; this does not guarantee immediate completion.
- If a hazard becomes urgent, residents should report the changed conditions instead of relying on the previous priority.
- For a submitted permit or business-licence application, contact Development Services through the process described in CH-PER-03.

7.3 Which process owns the issue?

Resident situation	Correct route
Noise from a nearby renovation	By-law complaint (CH-BYL-02), unless immediate danger.
Need approval to build a new deck	Permit application (CH-PER-03), not a service request.
Contractor blocks the public sidewalk with materials	311 obstruction report; Development Services may also review encroachment permit compliance.
Construction appears to violate approved permit	Development Services compliance review; 311 can route the concern.
Missed waste pickup	311 waste service request if eligible under page 4.

7.4 Privacy and records

Only collect information reasonably needed to process the case. Do not publish resident phone numbers, exact contact details or enforcement witness statements in public answer text. Internal case notes and third-party identities are not available through this public guide.

> Not covered. Compensation amounts, personnel names, exact case histories, complaint outcomes for specific addresses, procurement costs and internal escalation contacts are not in the supplied knowledge corpus.